

Design Scalable Web Apps Using Open Source

Scalability is an integral part of the software design process. Hence, applications must be designed such that their components can be de-coupled and then scale independently. The concept of scaling also requires one to design applications that have no footprint on the application server. This helps the application to quickly allocate/de-allocate servers.



“It was the best of times; it was the worst of times.” These opening lines in author Charles Dickens’ 1859 classic called ‘A Tale of Two Cities’ pretty much sum things up in our case. The time when you start getting an unexpected boost in the business, makes it a great period in the life cycle of the Web app. At the same time, you will experience times when the performance of your application drops drastically and the server crumbles. This is not a desirable state to be in when your business is growing. You have to get to scale — not only being able to scale things up when the business is up but also scale down when the load goes down.

“It won’t scale, if it’s not designed to scale.” This statement is true with any solution built on this planet. The ability to scale and be able to handle large amounts of traffic is something one needs to keep in mind while building solutions. This requires less effort if you focus on certain do’s and don’ts. In this article, we will primarily focus on certain challenges you may face while you consider incorporating the scalability factor into your Web apps. We will also cover architectural changes that might crop up while you adopt a specific design approach. The cloud is an integral part of addressing scale, and we will discuss a few